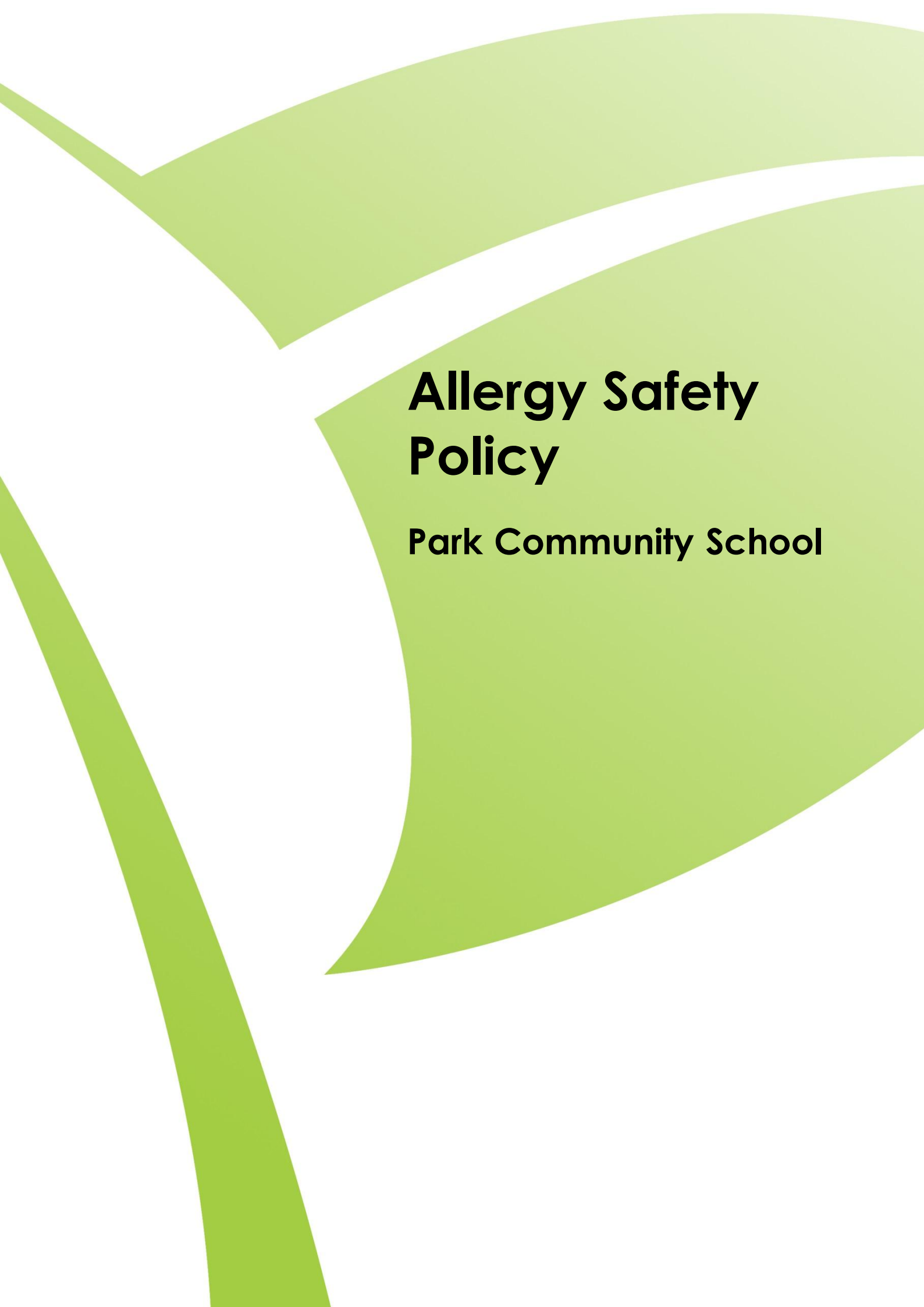




Allergy Safety Policy

Park Community School

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Park Community School Allergy Safety Policy

Approved by: Governing Body

Date approved: 16/09/2026

Review date: October 2027

1. Policy Statement

At Park Community School, we are committed to providing a safe, inclusive, and supportive environment for all pupils, staff, visitors, and members of the wider school community who have allergies. We recognise that allergies can have a significant impact on health, wellbeing, attendance, and participation in education.

This policy sets out the measures the school will take to minimise the risk of exposure to allergens, ensure effective emergency responses, and support the physical and emotional wellbeing of individuals with allergies.

This policy complies with the requirements of Section 34 of the Children's Wellbeing and Schools Act 2026 and should be read and used alongside the school's:

- Supporting Pupils with Medical Conditions Policy,
- First Aid Policy,
- Health and Safety Policy,
- Educational Visits Policy,
- Safeguarding Policy, Behaviour and Anti-Bullying Policies, and
- Data Protection Policy.

2. Roles and responsibilities

Headteacher

The headteacher has overall responsibility for implementing this policy and ensuring that appropriate systems are in place to safeguard pupils with allergies.

Named senior leader for allergy safety

The designated Allergy Safety Lead is:

Name: Ella Capaldi

Role: Head of School

Named Governor for allergy safety

The designated Allergy Safety Lead is

Name: Adrian Rowsell

Role: Governor

The Allergy Safety Lead will:

- Oversee the implementation of this policy.
- Maintain oversight of allergy records and Individual Healthcare Plans (IHPs).
- Ensure staff training is completed and recorded.
- Monitor allergy-related incidents and near misses.
- Lead annual reviews of the policy.
- Liaise with parents, healthcare professionals, and external agencies where required.
- Ensure that risks relating to pupils with allergy are included on the setting's relevant risk registers.

Staff

All staff are responsible for:

- Following this policy and associated procedures.
- Attending annual allergy awareness and emergency response training.
- Familiarising themselves with pupils' allergy needs and care plans where relevant.

- Responding appropriately in an emergency.
- Reporting allergy incidents and near misses.

Parents and carers

Parents and carers are responsible for:

- Informing the school of any diagnosed allergy.
- Providing up-to-date medical information and prescribed medication, clearly labelled.
- Supplying Allergy and /or Asthma Action Plans where applicable.
- Ensuring prescribed medication remains in date.
- Informing the school of any changes in medical circumstances.

Pupils

Where age and understanding permit, pupils are encouraged to:

- Take an active role in managing their allergies.
- Inform staff if they feel unwell or believe they have been exposed to an allergen.
- Carry prescribed medication where agreed and appropriate.
- Avoid sharing food.

3. Definitions

An allergy is a medical condition in which the body's immune system has an abnormal reaction to normally harmless substances such as food, insect stings, contact allergens and airborne allergens.

Anaphylaxis is a potentially fatal reaction affecting the Airway/Breathing/Circulation ("ABC"). Many individuals with allergies to food or insect stings are at risk of anaphylaxis.

Asthma is a lung disease caused by inflammation and tightening of the airways, it is frequently associated with allergy and anaphylaxis, because exposure to allergens can provoke an asthma attack, a potentially life-threatening condition.

Intolerance to foods or ingredients that the body is unable to digest is different to allergy and does not cause a serious allergic reaction. It can cause long term health problems if not avoided. Common food intolerances include lactose and gluten. Coeliac disease is a lifelong autoimmune condition to gluten, found in rye, barley and wheat.

4. Creating an allergy-aware culture

Allergy awareness training

All school staff present during times when pupils are on site will receive annual allergy awareness and emergency response training.

This includes, but is not limited to:

- teaching staff
- teaching assistants
- administrative staff
- catering staff
- site/facilities managers
- breakfast and after-school club staff
- agency and supply staff
- regular volunteers
- peripatetic staff.

Park Community School staff will have their training provided by the school; staff employed by wider organisations will have their training provided by their employer.

Annual allergy awareness and emergency response training will be delivered by a suitably qualified provider such as approved online training providers, or other competent healthcare professionals. Practical training in the use of prescribed and spare adrenaline auto-injectors will form part of annual refresher training; trainer devices of Epipen and /or Jext are used as part of our training.

The Allergy Safety Lead will ensure that annual training has been completed for all staff not employed directly by the school who work regularly with pupils.

New staff will receive allergy awareness and emergency response training as part of their induction, in line with other safeguarding training requirements.

Supply staff and temporary workers will be provided with information regarding pupils with severe allergies and emergency procedures before commencing duties.

Staff will also be informed where allergy information, Individual Healthcare Plans (IHPs), Allergy Action Plans, Asthma Action Plans and emergency procedures are stored and how these can be accessed quickly during normal school activities and emergency situations.

Annual training will cover, and ensure staff understand:

- What allergies are and the risks they present.
- The relationship between food allergy, asthma, eczema, hay fever, and other allergic conditions.
- The difference between food allergy, food intolerance, and coeliac disease.
- Known allergens within the school environment and where information on allergy triggers can be found.
- Symptoms of allergic reactions.
- The signs and symptoms of anaphylaxis.
- How to respond in an emergency:
- How to contact emergency services and inform parents.
- How to locate and administer adrenaline auto-injectors (ADs/AAls).
- How to locate and administer emergency asthma medication where required.
- How to access Allergy Action Plans and Individual Healthcare Plans.
- Their role in reducing allergen exposure.
- Procedures for reporting incidents and near misses.

Training records will be maintained by the Allergy Safety Lead.

5. Supporting wellbeing

The school recognises that living with allergies can contribute to anxiety and emotional distress.

Park Community School will:

- Foster an inclusive and supportive environment.
- Promote pupil confidence and independence in managing allergies.
- Support pupils who are able to self-manage their allergy with supervision as appropriate.
- Ensure pupils with allergies can participate fully in school life.
- Provide appropriate pastoral support where needed.

- Work closely with parents and carers to address concerns.
- Promote understanding of allergies through age-appropriate education.

Bullying and Discrimination

Bullying, teasing, intimidation, or exclusion relating to a pupil's allergy or medical condition will not be tolerated.

Any incidents will be managed in accordance with the school's Behaviour and Anti-Bullying Policies.

6. Minimising risk

Park Community School will take reasonable measures to reduce the likelihood of exposure to known allergens.

Measures include:

- Maintaining accurate allergy records.
- Informing relevant staff of allergy risks.
- Considering allergy risks during lesson planning and special events.
- Promoting good hygiene practices, including handwashing.
- Cleaning eating areas appropriately, and in line with guidance.
- Conducting individual risk assessments where necessary.

Curriculum activities

Staff planning activities involving food, animals, science experiments, art materials, cooking ingredients or other potential allergens will consider allergy risks beforehand, for example the use of cereal packets in junk modelling.

Suitable alternatives and reasonable adjustments will be provided where appropriate to ensure pupils are not excluded.

Airborne and Contact Allergens

Park Community School recognises that not all allergies are food related. Where a pupil has a known allergy to airborne or contact allergens, such as pollen, animal dander, dust mites, latex, fragrances, chemicals or other environmental allergens, the school will implement reasonable measures to minimise exposure.

These measures will consider:

- Adjustments to classroom seating arrangements.
- Restrictions on the use of specific products or materials.
- Enhanced cleaning arrangements.
- Consideration of allergens during curriculum activities.
- Additional supervision or risk management measures where necessary.

Any specific arrangements required will be recorded within the pupil's Individual Healthcare Plan and supported by individual risk assessments where appropriate.

7. Food allergy management

The school will work closely with catering providers where used, and families to manage food allergy risks.

Park Community will:

- Seek accurate allergen information from catering providers.
- Ensure pupils and families can access relevant allergen information.

- Encourage pupils not to share food or drinks.
- Communicate clearly regarding food-related school events.
- Assess risks associated with food brought into school.
- Employ at least two methods of identifying pupils with a known allergy at mealtimes, for example photographs displayed in staff-only areas and adult verification procedures.

School leaders will undertake suitable risk assessments and management arrangements for food brought onto the premises by pupils, staff, visitors and parents. Particular consideration will be given to celebrations, fundraising events, food technology lessons, cultural events, educational visits and any activity involving the preparation or sharing of food.

The school cannot guarantee an allergen-free environment but will take reasonable steps to minimise risk.

8. Identification and record keeping

Park Community School will maintain an up-to-date register of pupils with known allergies and, where voluntarily disclosed and necessary to support health and safety arrangements, records of staff and regular visitors with severe allergies.

Information regarding allergies will be collected:

- During admission processes
- Through annual medical information updates issued to all parents at the start of each academic year.
- Through Individual Healthcare Plan reviews.

Following notification from parents or healthcare professionals of any change in a pupil's medical condition.

Records will include:

- Pupils with allergies and the severity of reactions.
- Their known allergens.
- Prescribed medications and the location of their medication.
- Individual Healthcare Plans.
- Allergy Action Plans.
- Asthma Action Plans where relevant.
- Emergency contacts.

Information will be obtained from:

- Parents and carers.
- Healthcare professionals.
- Previous educational settings.
- Admission documentation.

All records will be reviewed at least annually by the Allergy Safety Lead and updated whenever circumstances change. The allergy register, associated Allergy Action Plans, Asthma Action Plans and Individual Healthcare Plans will be formally reviewed with parents and carers at least annually and whenever there is a significant change in medical advice, diagnosis or treatment.

9. Individual Healthcare Plans (IHPs)

An Individual Healthcare Plan will be developed for pupils where:

- Their allergy has a functional impact within the school environment.
- They are at risk of harm because of their allergy and they require arrangements that are additional to or different from those provided generally.

IHPs will set out:

- The pupil's allergy and known triggers.
- Symptoms requiring action.
- Preventative measures.
- Medication arrangements, including storage.
- Any reasonable adjustments required.
- Emergency procedures.
- Staff responsibilities.
- Educational visits arrangements.
- How the pupil's wellbeing will be supported, including how they will be supported to participate fully in school life.

Where provided, Allergy Action Plans and Asthma Action Plans will be attached to or referenced within the IHP.

Plans will be reviewed at least annually and following any significant reaction, or following changes to treatment or diagnosis.

10. Prescribed Adrenaline Devices (ADs) or Auto-Injectors (AIs)

Pupils prescribed ADs/AIs will have rapid access to their medication at all times. The school will ensure that pupils prescribed adrenaline devices are never more than five minutes from access to those devices during the school day, on educational visits and during extracurricular activities.

This includes enabling rapid access:

- In classrooms.
- During break and lunch periods.
- On sports fields.
- During educational visits.
- During extracurricular activities.

Medication storage locations will be known to all relevant staff and clearly identified. The ADs/AIs will be located in Reception, and clearly labelled

The school will maintain records of:

- Pupils prescribed ADs/AIs.
- The location of devices.
- Expiry dates.
- Relevant Action Plans.

Parents remain responsible for ensuring prescribed devices are supplied and replaced before expiry. Parents are encouraged to sign up for expiry date reminders on the device manufacturer website.

Where pupils routinely take prescribed ADs/AIs between home and school, parents and carers remain responsible for ensuring the devices accompany the pupil each day and remain in date. Pupils are encouraged to keep their devices in their school bag, ensuring they have access to them when travelling to or from school.

The school will undertake termly checks of recorded expiry dates and notify parents and carers when replacement medication is required.

11. Spare Adrenaline Auto-Injectors

The school will order ADs/AAs and emergency asthma inhalers from a registered pharmaceutical supplier.

Park Community School will maintain suitably located spare ADs/AAs where permitted and appropriate.

Storage

Spare ADs/AAs will:

- Be clearly labelled as emergency stock, with their strengths easily visible
- Be stored in pairs.
- Be easily accessible.
- Never be locked away.
- Be stored at room temperature, away from extremes of heat and direct sunlight.
- Be located so that emergency medication can reach a pupil within five minutes.

The school will organise the storage of prescribed and spare adrenaline devices so that no pupil at risk of anaphylaxis is more than five minutes from access to adrenaline at any point during the school day. Where required, additional emergency kits will be located in strategic areas of the school site to support this requirement.

The ADs/AAs will be located in Reception, and clearly labelled.

Monitoring

The school will maintain a listed record of all devices and their location, and

- Check expiry dates termly.
- Replace expired devices promptly.
- Replace devices promptly following use.
- Dispose of used devices safely in accordance with medical waste requirements.

Spare emergency kits may/will include:

- Spare AAs.
- Emergency asthma reliever inhaler.
- Spacers to support inhaler intake.
- Instructions for use.
- Emergency contacts.

'Spare' Asthma Inhalers

- Emergency asthma inhalers will only be given to pupils who have been prescribed an inhaler when their own inhaler is not available and where written parental and carer consent has been obtained to do so.

12. Educational visits and off-site activities

Pupils with allergies will be fully included in educational visits.

Risk assessments will be undertaken ahead of a planned trip and include consideration of:

- Itinerary and venue risks.
- Known allergens.

- Food arrangements.
- Access to emergency medication.
- Staff trained in emergency response.
- Emergency medical services available at the destination.
- Availability of a mobile phone signal.
- Contingency arrangements in the event of allergen exposure.

All staff and supporting adults on the trip will be briefed about the known allergen risks of pupils.

Pupils at risk of anaphylaxis will have access to their prescribed AD/AAI throughout the visit, by holding it themselves or it being held by a designated member of staff, identified in the risk assessment.

13. Responding to allergic reactions

In the event of an allergic reaction:

1. A member of staff will assess the situation immediately and remain with the pupil.
2. If there is an Action Plan in place, the emergency procedures outlined within it will be followed.
3. Adrenaline will be administered without delay where anaphylaxis is suspected.
4. Emergency services will be called.
5. Parents or carers will be informed as soon as possible.
6. The incident will be recorded and reviewed.

Where there is any doubt, staff will treat a suspected anaphylactic reaction as a medical emergency, including where a pupil with no known allergy presents with symptoms consistent with anaphylaxis.

- Staff will immediately call 999.
- A trained member of staff may administer a spare AD/AAI where permitted and clinically indicated.
- Parents and carers will be informed immediately.
- The incident will be investigated and appropriate medical follow-up encouraged.

14. Reporting serious incidents and near misses

All allergy-related incidents and near misses will be reported on the same day and, wherever possible, within two hours of the incident.

The report will include:

- Date and time.
- Individuals involved.
- Circumstances of exposure.
- Actions taken.
- Outcomes.
- Lessons learned.
- Parents will be informed.
- Risk assessments and procedures will be updated as necessary.

The Allergy Safety Lead will review incidents to identify improvements and reduce future risks, at least on a termly basis. Trends arising from incidents and near misses will be analysed and reported to senior leaders and governors as appropriate.

Lessons learned will be used to inform future policy reviews, staff training, risk assessments and wider allergy safety arrangements across the school.

Park Community School encourages parents and carers to report incidents occurring outside school that may be relevant to a pupil's safety within school.

15. Information sharing and confidentiality

The school will manage allergy information in accordance with UK GDPR and Data Protection legislation.

Information will only be shared on a need-to-know basis to protect a pupil's health and safety.

Relevant staff will have access to:

- Individual Healthcare Plans.
- Allergy Action Plans.
- Emergency procedures.

Information will be handled sensitively and respectfully at all times.

16. Raising awareness

This policy will be:

- Published on the school website.
- Available in hard copy on request.
- Included within staff induction processes.
- Referenced during annual allergy awareness training.

The school will promote age-appropriate allergy awareness amongst pupils and within its curriculum to help create a supportive and inclusive environment.

Where appropriate and agreed with parents and carers, peers may be taught how to seek help quickly if a pupil experiences an allergic reaction.

17. Monitoring and review

This policy will be reviewed annually by the Allergy Safety Lead and Governing Body, or sooner following:

- A serious allergic reaction.
- An anaphylaxis incident.
- A significant near miss.
- Changes in legislation or statutory guidance.
- Changes to school arrangements.

Document Control Table	
Associated Documents	
Date approved by governors	16 September 2026
Date of Review	

Appendix 1 – Useful Resources and Guidance

[Supporting pupils with medical conditions at school - GOV.UK](#)

[Allergy Safety in Schools statutory guidance](#)

[Government Allergy Safety Policy template](#)

[Individual Healthcare Plan for allergy template \(Gov.UK\)](#)

Allergic signs & symptoms

Allergic signs and symptoms need to be recognised early to ensure that the right treatment is given promptly.

Signs of an allergic reaction usually occur within minutes of being exposed to an allergen but can appear up to two hours after exposure. Mild to moderate allergic symptoms can be treated with antihistamine medication but should be considered as possible 'early warning signs' as mild reactions can quickly develop into more severe allergic reactions.



Signs of a mild to moderate allergic reaction may include one or more of the following:



Rash (hives),
redness, itchy skin



Swelling of the lips,
eyes or face



Itchy or
tingling mouth



Stomach pain,
nausea, vomiting

Signs of a severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) include one or more of the following symptoms which can be difficult to determine:



Airway:

- Swollen tongue
- Difficulty swallowing
- Throat tightness
- Change in voice (hoarse/croaky)



Breathing:

- Difficulty breathing
- Chest tightness
- Noisy breathing
- Persistent cough
- Wheeze



Circulation:

- Feeling dizzy or faint
- Collapse
- Loss of consciousness
- Pale and floppy (in babies/small children)

The 14 food allergens



Molluscs



Eggs



Fish



Lupin



Soya



Milk



Peanuts



Gluten



Crustaceans



Mustard



Nuts



Sesame



Celery



Sulphites



Appendix 4 - How to use an EpiPen

HOW TO USE AN EPIPEN®

For Severe Allergic Reactions (Anaphylaxis)

⚠️ USE IMMEDIATELY. DELAY CAN BE DANGEROUS. ⚠️

- 1 REMOVE FROM CASE**
 Pull EpiPen® out of carrier tube.
 Hold in your fist like a pen.


Do NOT pull thumb over either end.
- 2 PULL OFF BLUE SAFETY CAP**
 Pull straight up to remove.


Now it's activated and ready to use.
- 3 INJECT INTO OUTER THIGH**
 Place orange tip against outer thigh.
 Can inject through clothing if needed.


Push firmly until you hear a **CLICK!**
- 4 HOLD IN PLACE**
 Hold firmly against thigh for 3 seconds.

- 5 REMOVE AND MASSAGE**
 Remove EpiPen®.
 Massage injection area for about 10 seconds.

- 6 GET EMERGENCY HELP**


CALL 911

IMMEDIATELY

 - Effects can wear off.
 - Symptoms can come back.
 - A second dose may be needed in 5–15 minutes if symptoms persist.

IMPORTANT AFTER USING

-  Call 911 right away. Go to the nearest emergency room.
-  Symptoms can return even after getting better.
-  A second dose may be needed in 5–15 minutes if symptoms persist.

KEY TIPS

-  Always carry 2 EpiPens® with you.
-  Store at room temperature.
-  Avoid extreme heat and light.
-  Check expiration date regularly.
-  The solution should be clear and colorless. Replace if cloudy, discolored, or expired.



MEMORY TRICK: "BLUE TO THE SKY, ORANGE TO THE THIGH."



EpiPen® is a registered trademark of Mannes Specialty LLC.

Appendix 5 - Useful contacts

Key Personnel	Name (s)	Telephone No.
DSL	Jamie Bryce	07725 483353 023 92 489800 x 1260 safeguarding@pcs.hants.sch.uk
Deputy DSL(s)	Erika Leach Florence Fearon (DSL out of hours) Tammy Seaman Jo-Anne Breedon Sian Howes	07756 772089 023 92 489800 x 1216 07725 483351 023 92 489800 x 1207 07732 404829 023 92 489800 x 1257 023 92 489800 x 1246 023 92 489800 x 1258 safeguarding@pcs.hants.sch.uk
School's named Allergy lead	Ella Capaldi	07794039105 023 92 489813 safeguarding@pcs.hants.sch.uk
School's Mental Health Lead	Erika Leach	07756 772089 023 92 489800 x 1216 safeguarding@pcs.hants.sch.uk
Nominated Safeguarding Governor	Barry Harwood	Via PA to Headteacher 023 92 489801
Chair of Governors	Joint Chair: Barry Harwood Adrian Rowsell	Via PA to Headteacher 023 92 489801
Children's Services Reception Team		01329 225379
Out of hours Children's Services		0300 555 1373
Police	NPCC guidance	101 or in emergencies 999
Safeguarding advisors / Local Authority Designated Officers (LADOs)	Barbara Piddington Fiona Armfield Shona McMinn	HCC Safeguarding Unit 01962 876364 Child.protection@hants.gov.uk
School Matron	Laura May	023 92 489800 x 1244

Appendix 6 - Auto-injector locations

Auto-injector locations				
Set	Area	Size	Use by date	Location
Primary Campus				
A	Main hall/ restaurant	1 X 300mg 1 X 150mg	03/2027	On wall next to servery
B	Main office	3 X 150mg 1 X 300mg	03/2027	On wall next to red fire bag
Secondary Campus				
1	Reception	2x300mg EpiPens (6+) 2x150mg EpiPens(- 6)	06/2027 09/2027	Behind reception counter
2	KD3	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	09/2027	On top of the tambour on the right as you enter
3	KPA	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	03/2028	On top of the tambour on the left-hand side
4	Nursery	2x150mg EpiPens(- 6)	08/2027	In the kitchen with all medical supplies
5	Science work room	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	03/2028	Directly opposite the door with Defib
Off site facilities				
6	PDP/Inspired	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	09/2027	In an allergy case with first aid box at reception
7	APEX	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	09/2027	Stored in kitchen area with large first aid box.

8	Small Holding	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	09/2027	Stored in bee keeping cupboard, code 4316. Stored in allergy response bag and box.
9	Lift Off	2x300mg EpiPens (6+)	06/2027	Stored in the First aid room, ground floor.